HACKUTD 2026 · TEAM RESEARCH GUIDE

How to Win HackUTD 2026

What 1,148 past hackathon projects tell us about winning the General track and a sponsor track, explained in plain language.

1,148

past winning and non-winning projects read and rated

127

tracks where we compared 1st place with 2nd and 3rd

17

2026 sponsors, each with a one-line game plan

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Prepared 7 November 2026. Source files are in *HackUTD-2026-Research/outputs/*. Every number comes from a table in *data/tables/*.

SECTION 1

The short version

If you read only one page, read this one.

1. **Make it actually work, and show it working.**
   This was the clearest difference at HackUTD 2025. 75% of winners showed at least one feature really working, compared with 42% of strong non-winners. 23% of winners showed two working features; no strong non-winner did. Get one thing fully working first, then add a second. Never present a feature that isn't built.

2. **Nothing on a project page tells 1st place apart from 2nd and 3rd.**
   We compared them across 127 tracks and found no clear difference. The likely deciders are the things we can't see in the data: the live demo and how the team answers judges' questions. Rehearse both as seriously as the build.

3. **For the General track, don't make a plain dashboard the whole idea.**
   Only 6% of General 1st-place winners were "data in, charts out". It was the single most common shape among strong HackUTD projects that didn't win (48%).

4. **If you use AI, make it do several steps, visibly.**
   47% of HackUTD 2025 winners used AI that takes a chain of actions (an "agent"), compared with 28% of strong non-winners. A single question-and-answer call to a model is not a differentiator.

5. **Make the hard part visible.**
   Half of HackUTD 2025 winners showed their clever technical part on screen (a diagram, live logs, or the agent's steps), compared with 28% of strong non-winners.

6. **Company problem tracks: solve exactly the problem they asked. Their technology is optional.**
   22 of 24 HackUTD 2025 company-problem prizes went to projects that used none of the sponsor's own products.

7. **Tool prizes (NVIDIA, Spacetime, Photon, MLH): the tool must be essential.**
   85% of winners of these prizes built something that would stop working if you removed the sponsor's tool.

8. **Winning General plus a sponsor prize is possible but uncommon.**
   15% of General 1st-place winners also won a sponsor prize. Pick a sponsor track whose problem naturally fits your General idea, not a second unrelated idea.

9. **A clear title, images and a video keep you out of the "weak" pile, but don't make you a winner.**
   Nearly every strong project has them. Do them properly, then put your energy back into the demo.

10. **Put one real, cited number about the problem in your pitch.**
    30% of General 1st-place winners did, compared with 14% of 2nd and 3rd place.

SECTION 2

How we did this, and how much to trust it

What we looked at

We collected **1,148** hackathon projects from Devpost, mostly winners from student hackathons in 2024 to 2026, plus a sample of HackUTD 2025 projects that didn't win. An AI model read each project page without knowing whether it had won, and recorded about 40 things: what the project does, whether features were shown working, what kind of AI it used, how good the page looked, and so on. It also rated each project from 1 to 5 on the same six areas HackUTD judges use: innovation, technical complexity, completeness, design, impact and presentation.

The three comparisons

Comparison	What it tells us	Size
HackUTD 2025 winners vs non-winners	What gets a project into the winners' group at HackUTD. This is the only place we can compare winners with projects that didn't win.	36 winners vs 50 strong non-winners (marked "demo ready") and 50 random non-winners
1st place vs 2nd/3rd in the same track	What separates the very top from the rest of the top three.	127 tracks at many hackathons
General 1st-place winners	What kinds of projects win the General track. HackUTD doesn't publish 1st/2nd/3rd, so these come from other events.	65 projects

How to read the numbers in this guide

- **"Winners did X more often" means a pattern, not proof.** It doesn't prove X caused the win.
- **The 1-to-5 ratings are the AI reader's judgment**, not real judge scores. They're useful for comparing groups, not as exact scores.
- **Small groups are noisy.** When a difference is only 3 or 4 projects, treat it as a hint.
- **Two independent checks** re-rated 10 random projects each. They agreed with the original ratings 84% and 67% of the time. Agreement was weakest on the presentation and technical-complexity scores and on counting working features, so findings that rely on those are held at "medium" confidence at most.
- Every finding was then checked against the raw tables by a reviewer who hadn't written it. That review fixed 11 wrong numbers and dropped 2 findings.

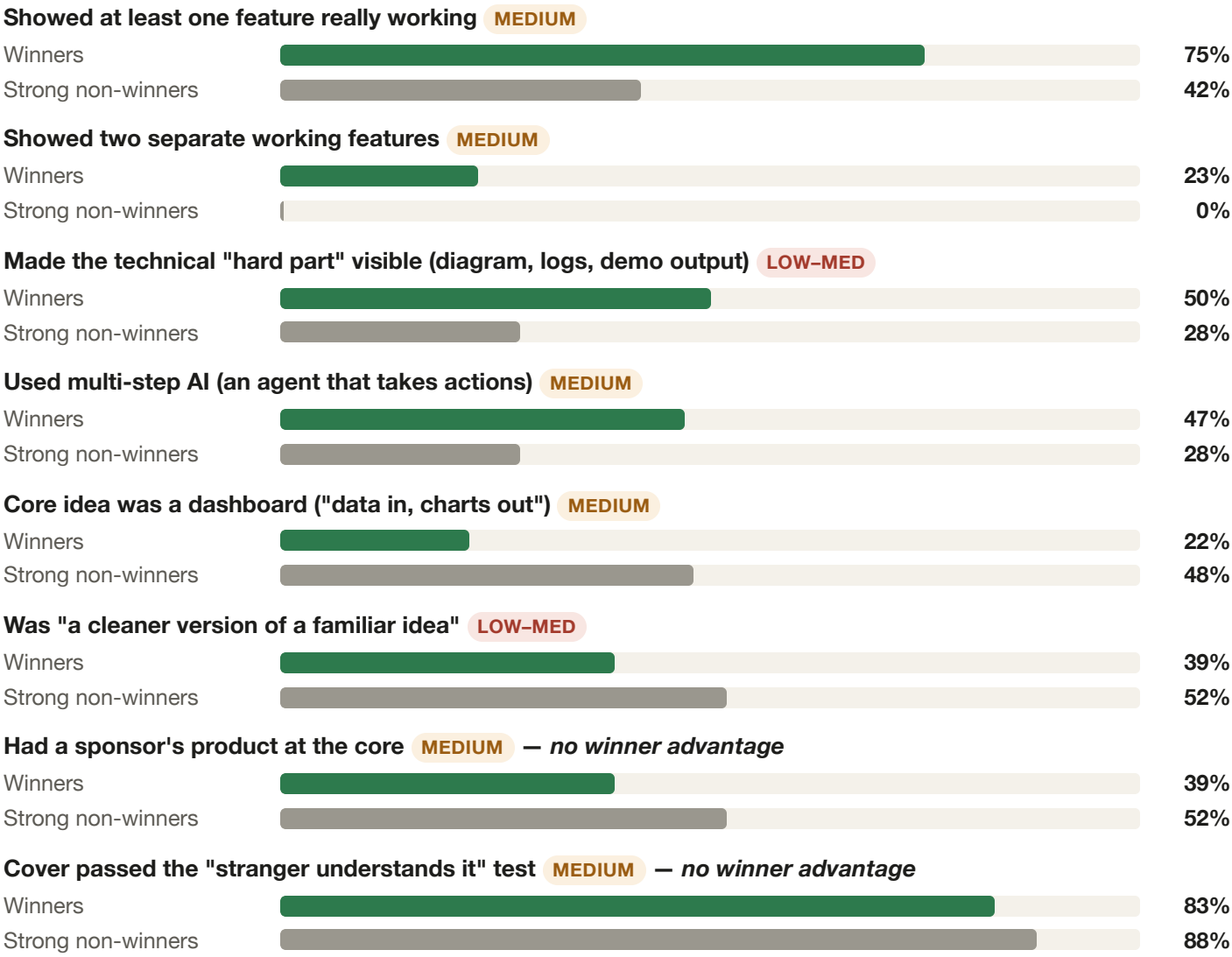
Confidence labels used below

Label	Meaning
HIGH	Directly counted, large enough groups. Rely on it.
MEDIUM	A clear pattern with reasonable group sizes. Good basis for decisions.
LOW	Small numbers or a lot of unknowns. Use as a tie-breaker only.

SECTION 3

What HackUTD winners do differently

HackUTD 2025 winners compared with strong non-winners (projects that looked demo-ready but didn't win). Green = winners, grey = strong non-winners.



Other things we checked: winners were more often rated 4 or 5 on completeness (22% vs 6%) and presentation (31% vs 14%), but these are small groups. No 2025 winner had a Devpost page with zero images, while 40% of random entries did. A small number of winners used hardware (14% vs 2%), but too few to rely on.

SECTION 4

What decides 1st vs 2nd place

The honest answer: nothing we can see on a Devpost page.

Across 127 tracks we compared each 1st-place project with the 2nd and 3rd-place projects in the same track. We set the bar at a gap of at least 20 percentage points. **No feature reached it** in the overall, General or sponsor comparisons. MEDIUM

The closest differences (all below the bar)

Difference	1st place	2nd / 3rd
Backed up impact with a cited statistic (General tracks)	30%	14%
Sensor or device that detects something and acts (General tracks)	16%	5%
Study, quiz or feedback app (General tracks)	3%	14%
Single call to an AI model as the whole product (General tracks)	8%	14%

Two narrow cases that did reach the bar

- **Theme tracks** (e.g. "sustainability", "health"): 1st-place projects more often had strong design, rated 4 or 5 (59% vs 26%).
- **Company problem tracks:** 1st place more often built exactly what the sponsor asked for (88% vs 67%). Half of these cases had unknown prompts, so this is LOW.

The judging areas

None of the six judging areas (innovation, technical complexity, completeness, design, impact, presentation) was a "must have" that every winner scored well on, and none separated 1st from 2nd. 1st-place projects were also not more "spiky" (great at one thing, weak at others). Their scores were, at most, slightly higher across the board. MEDIUM

What this means for us

- Treat every judging area as a gate: don't leave any of them weak.
- Don't bet on one standout area to carry you.
- Since the page doesn't decide 1st place, the **live demo and the judge Q&A** probably do. Rehearse them, and prepare answers to the questions in Section 8.

SECTION 5

The five kinds of General-track winners

We sorted 65 General 1st-place winners from other hackathons into recurring shapes. "HackUTD fit" is our judgment from reading the six HackUTD General winners from 2024 and 2025.

B. Multimodal human-need pipeline

16 of 65 (25%) · HackUTD fit **MEDIUM–STRONG**

Camera, voice or document input goes through an AI model to give a specific group of people something they couldn't do before, such as seeing, reading or coaching.

Example: TalkTuahBank (HackUTD 2024), a voice agent that does banking over a phone call for people without a smartphone. **Start brainstorming here.**

C. Agent / developer-tool automation

11 of 65 (17%) · HackUTD fit **STRONG**

Software that takes a developer or office task off someone's hands: AI agents that triage a bug, file tickets or run a computer by voice.

Examples: Working Memory (a VS Code extension, HackUTD 2025) and ProdigyPM (agents that push work to Jira, HackUTD 2025). That's 2 of the 6 HackUTD General winners, and this shape is getting more common. **Start brainstorming here.**

A. Hardware sense-and-act loop

22 of 65 (34%) · HackUTD fit **WEAK**

A physical device senses something, software decides, and something visible happens in the real world: a phone unlocks a bike lock, or a cane steers a blind user around obstacles.

The most common shape overall, but none of the 6 HackUTD General winners were hardware, and most examples come from longer 36–48 hour events. **Only choose this if the team already has hardware that works.**

D. Playful new interaction

9 of 65 (14%) · HackUTD fit **WEAK**

A game, toy or creative tool where the fun comes from a new way to play: a webcam as a controller, or betting on a live fish tank.

None of the HackUTD General winners were games.

E. Data-to-decision utility

4 of 65 (6%) · HackUTD fit **MEDIUM**

A planner or dashboard that turns real data into one decision for a clearly defined user.

Rare as a General winner but common as a sponsor winner (26% of sponsor 1sts). Fine for sponsor tracks; for General, add an action on top of the insight.

General vs sponsor winners look different. General 1st-place winners are more often games (12% vs 2%) or new ways of interacting (23% vs 15%). Sponsor 1st-place winners are more often dashboards, document tools and well-executed familiar ideas. To win both with one project: solve a sponsor's problem, but deliver it with a General-style twist (a new interaction or an unusual combination), not a plain dashboard.

SECTION 6

Sponsor tracks: the two kinds

PROBLEM-STYLE **"Solve our business problem"**

Banks, insurance, real estate, energy, telecom, NMC2, health, legal.

- Build **exactly** what the challenge asks, for the user it names.
- Their technology is optional: 22 of 24 HackUTD 2025 prizes of this kind used none.
- Use their data or API only if the challenge provides it.

TOOL-STYLE **"Use our product"**

NVIDIA, Spacetime, Photon and MLH tool prizes.

- The tool must be essential: the project breaks without it (85% of winners).
- One or two features used properly is enough; show them working in the demo.
- Never add the tool as an afterthought.

Winning General + a sponsor prize

Most winners win one prize. At HackUTD, 12 of 69 winners (17%) won two or more. 15% of General 1st-place winners also won a sponsor prize. Two of the three 2024 HackUTD General winners (Lumo and TalkTuahBank) also won the Goldman Sachs track. **Plan:** choose the sponsor whose problem fits your General idea, then add one MLH or side prize for a tool the build already uses.

Less crowded tracks

In a sample of 100 HackUTD 2025 non-winners, **none** entered State Farm or Goldman Sachs, yet each gave out 3 prizes. Meanwhile, 26 of the 100 entered NVIDIA, 16 entered Toyota and 16 entered T-Mobile. It's only a sample, but when two tracks fit equally well, lean towards the one fewer teams seem to pick. LOW

What past winners built, by industry

Industry (2026 sponsors)	Most common winning shapes
Banking (Capital One, PNC, Goldman Sachs, Toyota FS)	Dashboards that lead to a decision (36 of 85), automation agents (10), document-to-action tools (7)
Insurance (State Farm)	Education and feedback apps (5 of 14), developer tools (3)
Telecom (T-Mobile, AT&T)	Dashboards (6 of 12), risk detection (2)
Real estate (CBRE)	Dashboards (7 of 17), document-to-action tools (5)
Energy (EOG)	Dashboards (4 of 9), risk detection (3)
AI compute (NVIDIA, NMC2, 8090 AI)	Automation agents (31 of 123), risk detection (14), vision assistants (12)
Cloud / dev tools (Spacetime, NMC2)	Automation agents (18 of 102), dashboards (17), developer tools (12)
Health (Axxess)	Document-to-action tools (5 of 17), voice-to-action (3)

Every 2026 sponsor in one line

"Past wins" counts that sponsor's prizes in our data, from HackUTD and other hackathons. All 2026 challenge texts are revealed at the start of hacking, so each idea below is our suggestion, not a confirmed prompt. Full cards are in *outputs/sponsor_cards.md*.

Sponsor	Type	Past wins	What past winners did · what to pitch
T-Mobile	PROBLEM	7	HackUTD 2025 winners were near-identical sentiment dashboards for product managers, and the track was crowded. None needed a T-Mobile product. Name a specific user, show a ranked list of actions, and be different from 2025.
Capital One	PROBLEM + some tool prizes	42	Mostly problem-fit; 9 of 42 were API prizes. Ideas: personal-finance coach, fraud explainer, financial-inclusion tool for students, built on synthetic data.
Goldman Sachs	PROBLEM	6	Few teams entered in 2025. Ideas: a risk explainer or portfolio stress test for retail investors, in plain English; polish the design.
PNC Bank	PROBLEM	6	Lead with a payments or fraud problem: payee verification, instant payouts for gig workers, a check-deposit assistant.
Toyota Financial	PROBLEM	6	True cost of owning a car with what-if interest rates, or a first-time-buyer assistant. Show a before/after cost on screen.
State Farm	PROBLEM	13	No sampled 2025 non-winner entered it. Past winners were most often education/feedback apps. Ideas: disaster preparedness, teen-driver coaching. Make the community benefit obvious.
CBRE	PROBLEM	17	Answers that cite sources with confidence levels, or pulling tables out of documents. Their rubric: business impact, innovation, scalability, market readiness, execution.
EOG Resources	PROBLEM	4	Little data. Ideas: an anomaly detector with a "cost saved" number, or a mobile field dashboard with alerts.
NMC2	PROBLEM	6	All 6 past winners used no NMC technology. Treat it as a datacenter/AI-operations problem: an ops copilot or a GPU power visualiser.
NVIDIA	TOOL	21	Use 1–2 NVIDIA features as a core part of the build, shown in the demo. A crowded track in 2025. Ideas: a tool-calling agent on Nemotron, a vision-language document app.
Spacetime	TOOL	12	All 12 past winners used SpacetimeDB as their core backend. Get the challenge spec early; never enter as an afterthought.
Photon	TOOL	17	The messaging layer was core in 13 of 17 winners. Ideas: a campus assistant over iMessage or a group-chat agent. One feature is enough; show a live text exchange.
Axxess	NO DATA	0	Health-care workflow on synthetic data, such as voice-to-visit-notes for clinicians. Make it clear no real patient data is used.
Winstead PC	NO DATA	0	A law-firm tool, such as lease or contract summaries where every claim links to the source clause. Stress accuracy and a human reviewing the output.
8090 AI	NO DATA	0	Ask at the booth what wins. Possible direction: tracing requirements to tests for legacy software.
Niantic Spatial	NO DATA	0	A real place scanned and located live at your table (e.g. campus wayfinding). Needs mobile/Unity skills.
AT&T	NO DATA	0	No prize listed. Don't plan around it; check at opening.

SECTION 7

What to build, and what to avoid

The minimum winning build

- **One complete user journey that works** on real or clearly-seeded data, from start to finish. 72% of General 1st-place winners showed exactly one.
- **A second working journey only once the first is solid**, since this is what set HackUTD 2025 winners apart.
- **One genuinely hard technical piece** that the demo uses: a multi-step pipeline, an agent with tools, a custom model or hardware. 58% of General 1st-place winners had a multi-input pipeline or hardware at their core.
- **Only use outside services you're sure will work at the table.** Most General winners used 0–4.
- **Be honest about what's simulated.** Anything the demo touches must be live, not hardcoded.

Avoid list (for the General track)

These show up more among 2nd/3rd than 1st. The gaps are small, so treat them as warnings, not bans. They're fine if a sponsor explicitly asks for one.

- A study, quiz or feedback app (3% of General 1sts vs 14% of 2nd/3rd).
- A thin wrapper around one AI prompt.
- A dashboard over a public dataset as the whole product.
- "We used a new dataset" as the only new thing.
- Any feature in the pitch that doesn't actually work.

Common now vs still special

Common among recent winners

Not a differentiator by itself.

- Live data (65% of recent winners)
- Agentic AI (26%, up from 9%)
- A demo video and images
- Full Devpost sections

Still stands out

Worth aiming for.

- A physical or real-world interaction
- The hard part visible on screen
- A second working feature
- A cited number about the problem

The "wow moment"

In winning write-ups, the memorable moment is often the system **acting on the real world or on the judge's own input**, live. Examples: "Phone unlocks the 3D-printed bike lock over NFC" (REMI). "Brain waves change the tempo of live-generated music" (Duet). "Call the Mac on FaceTime; the agent answers by voice, does the task and texts back a screenshot" (FaceTimeOS). Design one moment like this into your demo.

SECTION 8

Presenting: cover, page, video, pitch and questions

The cover (title + tagline)

It must say **who it's for** and **what it does** in one line: "*Name — what it does for whom.*" Test it on someone from another team: if they can't say what it does after reading only the title, rewrite it.

Good (real 1st-place winners)	Bad (real 1st-place winners that scored low)
"FaceTimeOS — FaceTime to talk, see, and control your MacBook with AI agents" "PrezPal — A voice-controlled custom slides editor, powered by generative AI"	"Redefining mobile computing." "Connect color to a sound" "."

The Devpost page

- Embedded demo video (84% of General 1sts).
- Four or more images, starting with the product working, not a logo (66% of General 1sts had 4+).
- All standard sections: Inspiration (with one cited number), What it does (named user and the journey), How we built it (the hard part), Challenges, Accomplishments, What we learned, What's next.
- List only the sponsor and MLH tools you actually used, and name the sponsor challenge you answered in plain words.

The demo video (HackUTD rule: demo only, 2 minutes max)

- Open on the working result, not a title card or problem slide.
- Show the main journey live, the wow moment, and the hard part on screen.
- Record from the finished build, and keep a local copy at your table as a backup.

The pitch at your table (repeat for each judge group)

1. One line: who the user is, their problem, and one cited number.
2. Show the working result straight away: the wow moment.
3. Walk through the main journey on prepared data, saying what the system is doing.
4. Show the hard part: open the logs, agent steps or diagram next to the result.
5. Say what's real, what's simulated, and what's next.
6. Sponsor line: "For [sponsor], this solves [their stated problem] for [their named user]."
7. Invite questions. Keep a one-click reset ready for the next group.

Questions judges are likely to ask

Question	How to answer
"What did you build yourselves vs call an API for?"	Point at the hard part on screen and name the steps you wrote.
"Is this live or hardcoded?"	Show the data source live; say exactly what's prepared or simulated.
"What if the AI is wrong or the sensor fails?"	Show the fallback or check; if there isn't one, say what you'd add.
"Who's the user, and how do you know it's a real problem?"	Name the user and give the cited number, plus anything you heard from real people at the event.
"How does this use [sponsor]'s product or answer their challenge?"	Problem track: restate their challenge and show the matching output. Tool track: show the feature that's essential and what breaks without it.
"How is this different from [famous product]?"	The new combination or new interaction, in one sentence.
"What would you do next?"	The next concrete feature and what you'd measure.
"How did you split the work?"	One sentence per person, each tied to a visible part.

SECTION 9

Game plan for track announcement

Before opening

□ Accounts and API keys ready for likely tools (NVIDIA, MLH prizes, hosting). Never commit keys to the repo.
□ Read Section 6 (sponsors) and Section 5 (the five kinds of winners).
□ Don't write submission code in advance (prior-work rule). Reading docs and throwaway practice are fine.

Confirm at the opening ceremony

□ Can one project win General and sponsor prizes together?
□ Are MLH/side prizes outside the 2-sponsor-track limit?
□ What do NMC2, 8090 AI, Spacetime and Photon actually ask for?
□ Prior-work rules; does the repo have to be public?
□ How judging works: groups per table, a second round, the rubric.

When tracks are announced

1. **Sort each track:** problem-style, tool-style, or open theme (Section 6).
2. **Come up with 3–5 ideas,** each as: problem + main sponsor track + one extra prize. Start from shapes B (multimodal) and C (agents). Use A (hardware) only if you already have working hardware.
3. **Drop any idea that fails a check:**
    - It isn't eligible under the rules.
    - You can't describe the demo in one sentence ("Judge says X into the mic, and the device does Y").
    - You can't see a clear path to one working journey.
4. **Score the survivors** with the sheet below. A 1 or 2 in any row means fix it or drop it, whatever the total.
5. **Commit to one.** Then, in order: initial Devpost entry by its deadline → build journey 1 → freeze features once it's stable → optional journey 2 → test → record the video → finish Devpost → rehearse the pitch and questions → submit.

At the table

□ Cover screen that passes the stranger test.
□ Prepared demo data and a one-click reset.
□ Backup video saved locally.

Idea scoring sheet

Score each idea 1–5 per row. Total = sum of (score × weight) ÷ 5, out of 100. It's a discussion tool, not an oracle.

Criterion	Weight	A 5 looks like…	A 1 looks like…	Idea 1	Idea 2	Idea 3
General-track strength	25	Matches a winner shape; visible hard part	Dashboard over public data; one-prompt wrapper			
Demo memorability	20	Judge sees it act on the real world or their own input	Slides and a chart			
Sponsor fit	15	Exactly what the challenge asked, for its named user	Loose theme match			
Feasibility for 4 people	15	Clear path to one working journey with known tools	Depends on an unknown API or hardware we lack			
User value	10	Specific user + a cited number	"Everyone" + vague impact			
Distinctiveness	10	New combination or new interaction	This year's common AI idea			
Extra prize fit	5	The build already needs that tool	Tool added only for the prize			
Total	**100**					

SECTION 10

What we don't know

- **How judges actually behaved.** We only see project pages, not live demos or Q&A, and that's probably where 1st place is decided.
- **Video timing.** We didn't watch the demo videos, so "how early to show the result" is advice, not a measurement.
- **Repeat-winning teams.** Not analysed, because team member links in the data weren't reliable.
- **HackUTD's own 1st/2nd/3rd.** HackUTD doesn't publish placements, so the 1st-vs-2nd analysis uses other hackathons.
- **Five sponsors have no past data** (Axxess, Winstead PC, 8090 AI, Niantic Spatial, AT&T); their advice comes from the sponsor briefs only.
- **Sponsor challenge texts** were unknown for about half of past sponsor prizes, so "build exactly what they asked" is based on the half we could check.
- **The cover test has a ceiling:** 78% of all projects passed it fully, so it catches bad covers but can't rank good ones.
- **Prize stacking is undercounted:** the data doesn't list every prize winner per track, so the real share of projects that won 2+ prizes may be a bit higher.

APPENDIX A

Every research question, answered in one line

The questions come from *01_ANALYSIS_SPEC.md*. Detailed evidence for each is in *outputs/findings.md*.

#	Question	Answer
Q0	What separates HackUTD 2025 winners from strong non-winners?	More working features shown, multi-step AI, the hard part made visible, and not being a plain dashboard. Sponsor-product use and cover quality didn't matter.
Q1	What differs between 1st and 2nd/3rd in the same track?	Nothing visible on the page reaches our bar. Closest: a cited statistic (30% vs 14% in General).
Q2	Which judging areas are must-haves, and which win 1st?	None is a must-have and none separates 1st. Treat all six as gates.
Q3	Do 1sts win by being balanced or by one standout strength?	Not spikier. At most slightly higher across the board.
Q4	What kinds of projects win General 1st?	Five shapes: hardware loop, multimodal pipeline, agent automation, playful interaction, data-to-decision (Section 5).
Q5	What is the minimum winning build?	One complete working journey, one genuinely hard piece, 0–4 outside services, honest about what's simulated.
Q6	Where is the technical "hard part", and how is it shown?	Usually a multi-input pipeline or hardware (58%). HackUTD winners showed it on screen more often (50% vs 28%).
Q7	Where does novelty come from?	Combinations and new interactions. "Cleaner version of a familiar idea" is less common among winners.
Q8	How specific is the problem framing?	Winners more often name a specific user (86% vs 76% of strong non-winners). A small gap, but consistent.
Q9	How do projects win multiple prizes?	A minority do (15% of General 1sts; 17% of HackUTD winners). Most often General + a tool prize or sponsor prize.
Q10	What separates sponsor 1st from 2nd/3rd?	Building exactly what was asked (88% vs 67%, low confidence). Amount of sponsor tech used doesn't differ.
Q11	Which project shapes win in each sponsor industry?	See the industry table in Section 6. Sponsor tracks reward dashboards far more than General does.
Q12	How much sponsor-tool use does a tool prize need?	The tool must be essential (85%); one feature used properly is common (55%).
Q13	Playbook for each sponsor	One line per sponsor in Section 6; full cards in sponsor_cards.md.
Q14	Do sponsor winners echo the challenge's wording?	Barely. Prompt words in the title: 42% vs 36%. Matching the problem matters more than the words.
Q15	Can a stranger understand the project from the cover?	Most winners pass (81–85%), but so do most others. It filters out weak projects only.
Q16	When does the working result appear in the video?	**Not measured** (videos weren't watched). Wow moments were taken from page text instead.
Q17	How do winners make impact believable?	Mostly they don't: 69% of General 1sts give no evidence beyond claims. A cited statistic is the most common evidence.
Q18	What does a winning Devpost page contain?	A video, 4+ images and all standard sections. Typical, not universal. Architecture diagrams are uncommon (22%).
Q19	What do HackUTD winners specifically share?	Company prizes went to projects that solved the business problem without the sponsor's product (22 of 24).

Q20	What has changed recently?	Agentic AI rose from 9% to 26% of winners, and live data from 56% to 65%. Common now, but not required.
Q21	Calibration: HarmoniQ (2025 T-Mobile 3rd) vs that track's 1st and 2nd	Biggest gaps: technical complexity and completeness (static data, a missing endpoint). A single case, so an anecdote only.
Q22	What do repeat-winning teams do every time?	**Not done.** Team member links weren't reliable.
Q23	What places often but rarely takes 1st?	Study/quiz apps, one-prompt wrappers, plain dashboards and "new dataset" ideas (all small gaps).